

Project Charter — Azkashine Job Portal v1

Owner: Nazir Hasan (Acting Project Manager) **Date:** 2026-05-09 **Status:** Draft — for Product Owner review and sign-off **Target QA handover:** 2026-06-15

A note on this document

This Charter is written in plain language so the Product Owner, Sponsor, and any non-technical stakeholder can read it end-to-end and make informed decisions without needing a developer to translate. Where we cite numbers, prices, or competitor practices, the source is our [industry research document](#). The technical contract for the build team lives separately in `02-scope-locked.md` and is not intended for non-technical reading.

1. What we are building, in one paragraph

Azkashine Job Portal connects **Potential workers & Domain Specialists In India** with **employers** through a mobile-first, multilingual platform. Workers sign up with just a phone number, browse jobs in their language, and *also* can apply with a voice message. Employers post jobs, review candidates, and schedule interviews. A small Azkashine admin team verifies corporate employers and moderates job posts. The platform works on the web and as a mobile app, supports 10 Indian languages, and uses WhatsApp to keep workers updated. We make money from **subscriptions only**; we never handle the wages between workers and employers.

2. Why this product, why now

The market is large and underserved. Apna alone has tens of millions of users; WorkIndia has tens of millions; Naukri owns the white-collar segment. The blue-collar and domain-specialist segments — construction, food delivery, factory work, domestic help, retail, repair services, and the long tail of skilled-but-fragmented trades — remain fragmented. *Indian workers who possess alternative skills across different job domains require a stable platform for their employment.*

Where existing platforms fall short:

- **Language reach.** Apna offers 11 languages, but WorkIndia is only Hindi and English. Workers from Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Kerala, Odisha, West Bengal, and Gujarat are partly excluded by the Hindi-English-only platforms.
- **Voice-first communication.** Most platforms are text-heavy. Workers who can't read fluently struggle.

- **WhatsApp gap.** Workers live in WhatsApp, but most platforms send notifications by SMS, which often goes to spam or shows up as "unknown sender." WhatsApp open rates are 80%+ versus around 30% for SMS.

Our angle: 10 Indian languages from day one, voice messages on chat and applications, phone-only signup, WhatsApp-native notifications, and a low-friction premium tier (model TBD with your input — see Section 7).

3. Who uses this product

3.1 Job Seeker — primary user

Workers like Sanjay RK — unskilled, mobile-first, low literacy, owns a basic Android phone, speaks one of 10 Indian languages: English, Hindi, Tamil, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi, Gujarati, Odia, Telugu, or Bengali. Uses both the mobile app (primary) and the website (secondary).

3.2 Employer — secondary user

Two types:

- **Individual** (e.g., a household hiring domestic help) — instantly approved after signup
- **Corporate** (a company) — submits business documents (GST, CIN, ISO certificates) and waits for our admin team to approve

Uses both web and mobile.

3.3 Admin — internal Azkashine team

A small team that verifies corporate employer documents, moderates job posts using an AI-assisted "Scan Content" feature, manages payments and user complaints, and views revenue dashboards. Uses a separate web app (no admin mobile app).

4. What we are building in v1

4.1 For job seekers (workers)

- **Phone-only signup.** Enter phone number, get a 6-digit code via SMS or WhatsApp, set up profile (name, email, sector, job title, work experience, optional documents), set a password.
- **Login three ways.** Phone + OTP, email + password, or "Sign in with Google" — whichever is easiest.
- **10 Indian languages.** English and Hindi will be 100% complete at launch; the other 8 may have minor gaps if our language reviewers are still finishing.

- **Two job feeds.** "Recommended for you" (sorted by best match to your profile and location) and "Jobs Nearby" (sorted by distance only).
- **Apply with voice.** Record up to a 2-minute voice message about why you're a fit, optionally add text. The same 2-minute cap applies on web and mobile.
- **Save jobs for later. See your applications.**
- **Chat with employers.** Text and voice messages up to 60 seconds. Refreshes automatically when chat is open.
- **Free vs paid.** Free users browse jobs; paid users get extra premium features (exact mechanics for you to decide — see Section 7).
- **Notifications.** In-app, phone push, SMS for OTP and payment, WhatsApp for application status, interview reminders, and recruiter messages. Email only for password reset.

4.2 For employers

- **Two registration paths.** Individual (instant approval) and Corporate (waits for our admin team's review of business documents).
- **Phone-only signup** plus alternative login methods (email + password or Google).
- **Free trial + paid plan.** Exact pricing decision is yours (Section 7).
- **Post jobs** with rich descriptions, salary ranges, location, urgency, and a live preview before publishing.
- **Manage candidates.** See applicants, mark them as Accepted / Rejected / Bookmarked / Shortlisted; view their profile, resume, and voice introduction.
- **Schedule interviews.** Pick date, time, optional notes. (Adding the interview *mode* — in-person, phone, video — is a small confirmation we want from you in our next sync.)
- **Send interview reminders.** Workers get a WhatsApp message, with SMS as backup, 24 hours and 2 hours before the interview.
- **Day-after the interview.** Three quick buttons for the employer: Hired / Did not show up / Need re-interview.
- **Toggle visibility** of phone or email per job post — controls whether seekers can use "Contact Recruiter" once they've upgraded.
- **Available on web AND mobile** — same features on both. Mobile lets recruiters review candidates while travelling or between meetings.

4.3 For our admin team

- **Verification queues.** Review and approve / reject corporate employer registrations. Manually verify uploaded documents (no AI auto-verification in v1).
- **Job post moderation.** Every post gets a one-click "**Scan Content**" button that uses OpenAI's free moderation tool plus our own checks for Indian scam patterns (registration fees, MLM language,

"earn lakhs by recruiting", free-mail HR contacts pretending to be from real corporates). Admin still has the final word.

- **Send warnings or delete** posts that violate rules.
- **Revenue and subscription dashboards.**
- **Soft-delete users** — recoverable, not gone forever.
- **Web only.** No mobile admin app.

4.4 Behind the scenes (the technical layer)

- **Notifications** flow through five channels:
 - In-app messages
 - Phone push notifications (FCM)
 - **WhatsApp Business** for application status updates, interview scheduling and reminders, recruiter contact, payment confirmations
 - SMS for OTP and payment confirmation (and as a fallback when WhatsApp delivery fails)
 - Email for password reset and corporate-approval outcomes
 - **Voice messages** stored on our server; a one-line config change moves storage to cloud (S3) when we scale.
 - **Razorpay** for all payments (UPI, cards, net banking).
 - **One backend** serves web, mobile, and admin.
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5. What we are NOT building in v1 — and why

5.1 Things deferred to a later version (v2+)

Feature	Why it's deferred
Voice playback engine for the whole interface (the 🗣️ icons stay as design placeholders, not functional yet)	The audio engine is its own project — pre-recorded voice vs cloud TTS vs device TTS is a separate research and build effort.
AI auto-verification of documents (OCR, photo matching)	Admin verifies manually in v1. Building OCR + photo-match + name-match is a separate AI project.
Skill testing (online tests, field assessments)	Workers self-declare skills in v1. Skill testing is a separate product line with field operations.
Job ratings and reviews after work is done	Adds complexity. Not core to the hiring loop — workers want jobs, employers want applicants.
Auto-renewing subscriptions	RBI requires a 24-hour pre-debit notification surface for auto-debit — adds workflow we don't need to ship in v1. Manual renewal is fine.

6. Research-backed decisions

Two decisions worth explaining because they're driven by research rather than instinct.

6.1 Aadhaar — we removed it entirely

Original plan: collect a 12-digit Aadhaar number at signup, validate the format, send an OTP to the phone (mock verification, not a real UIDAI lookup).

What research told us:

- **Apna and WorkIndia don't require Aadhaar.** They use phone OTP only at signup. We were on track to be the *only* platform requiring an extra ID number — adding friction at the wrong moment of the funnel.
- **The Supreme Court (Puttaswamy 2018) bars private companies from making Aadhaar mandatory.** So we'd have had to build PAN, Driving Licence, and Voter ID alternative paths anyway — extra screens, extra admin verification work.
- **Real Aadhaar verification needs an AUA-licensed partner** (IDfy, Signzy, HyperVerge, or Karza) — 3+ months of contract setup. Not realistic in 6 weeks.

Decision: removed entirely. Phone OTP only at signup. About a week of engineering effort saved, and the registration flow is now closer to what Indian workers expect from competitors.

6.2 WhatsApp Business is in v1

Why we use WhatsApp Business for notifications:

- **Indian workers live in WhatsApp.** Open rates run 80%+ for transactional WhatsApp messages versus around 30% for SMS in the same population.
- **WhatsApp utility templates cost ~₹0.115 per message** versus ₹0.18–0.25 for DLT-registered SMS. At our notification volume — application updates, interview reminders, payment confirmations — the cost difference adds up.
- **Workers can reply** to recruiter messages right inside WhatsApp without switching apps.

We use **MSG91** as our WhatsApp provider (already in our stack for SMS). Engineering integration takes 5–7 days. The supporting work — Meta Business verification, BSP onboarding, template approval — runs in parallel as a non-engineering workstream and takes 1–3 weeks elapsed.

One acceptable risk: if Meta verification slips, WhatsApp launches up to a week *after* QA handover (June 15) instead of at handover. SMS stays as fallback throughout, so no critical notification is ever undelivered.

7. Pricing — provisional Option B; awaiting your confirmation

Pricing is the single most important decision for this product. The full analysis — competitor matrices, revenue projections at different scales, India-specific tax and regulatory factors, and the trade-offs of each pricing pattern — is in a separate Pricing Decision Memo:

 [docs/managerial/03-pricing-decision-memo.md](#)

The memo presents 3 concrete pricing options (A / B / C) with the data needed to choose between them, plus our recommendation.

To unblock Sprint 1, we are proceeding with Option B as the working assumption (worker free; employer ₹999/month with 14-day trial). This is documented in [03-pricing-decision-provisional.md](#). If you want different numbers or a different option (A / C / a variant), please confirm by **2026-05-18** — anything you say will override the provisional state. If we don't hear back by then, Option B ships as v1 default and can still be revised in v1.1 based on first-launch month learnings.

8. How we'll deliver

8.1 Team

Role	Person	What they own
Frontend developer + acting Project Manager	Nazir Hasan	Public website, admin website, FE/BE alignment, all PM artefacts
Backend developer	Asrar	Backend API, Razorpay integration, Aadhaar code removal, WhatsApp integration
Mobile developer	Dheeraj	Mobile app for both workers and employers (React Native + Expo)
WhatsApp / Meta verification + operations	TBD (non-engineering)	Owns Meta Business verification, BSP onboarding with MSG91, template drafting and approval — runs in parallel with engineering
Translation reviewers (10 languages)	Coordinated by Nazir	Native-speaker review of AI-translated UI text
Infrastructure	Separate team	Hosting, deployment, staging environment by mid-May
Quality Assurance	Separate team	UAT begins 2026-06-15

8.2 Sprint plan in plain English

Sprint	Dates	What we'll have at the end
Sprint 0 — Foundation	May 5–10	This Charter signed off; PRD, RTM, sprint backlog written; Dheeraj onboarded; Meta verification process begun
Sprint 1 — Authentication + Subscription + Plumbing	May 11–24	Workers and employers can sign up with phone OTP, log in via email or Google, on both web and mobile; subscriptions wired up using your chosen pricing model; WhatsApp + SMS infrastructure in flight
Sprint 2 — Core flows + integrations	May 25 – Jun 7	Apply with voice, candidate management, chat, admin moderation, English + Hindi UI complete and reviewed
Sprint 3 — Polish + QA prep	Jun 8–14	Bug fixes, performance check, security review, seed data loaded, deployed to staging. Code freeze June 14, handover June 15.
QA UAT	June 15 onwards	QA team runs scenarios; we fix only blockers. WhatsApp goes live in week 1 of UAT if Meta approval came through during the build.

9. Success criteria for QA handover (June 15, 2026)

By June 15, we must have:

- **Three apps deployed to staging** — the public website, the admin website, the mobile app — all using real authentication (no mock data on critical paths).
 - **A worker can:** sign up via phone OTP, complete profile, browse Recommended + Nearby jobs, apply with a voice message, chat with an employer, pay (whatever pricing model you chose), receive notifications.
 - **An employer (Individual or Corporate) can:** sign up, get verified or instantly approved, post a job, review applicants, schedule an interview, pay, message a worker.
 - **An admin can:** process verification queues, scan content with OpenAI moderation, send warnings, delete violating posts, see revenue dashboard.
 - **English + Hindi UI:** 100% complete and reviewed. Other 8 languages: at minimum present, with [needs review] markers if anything is missing.
 - **The backend has:** Razorpay subscription module, phone-OTP auth + Email + Google login, content moderation via OpenAI + India scam regex, all 11 notification types delivered through the channel matrix (in-app + push + SMS for critical + email for sensitive + WhatsApp where templates are approved).
 - **Seed data loaded** — job categories from our 11 spreadsheets, an admin user, sample employers.
 - **API contract published** in docs/technical/ ; **QA pack delivered** — test accounts, environment URLs, known limitations, regression scenarios.
 - **Code freeze** holds from June 14; only blocker fixes during UAT.
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10. Sign-off

By signing below, the named parties confirm scope, timeline, and ownership as defined above. Scope changes after sign-off require explicit override of `02-scope-locked.md` and a Charter revision.

Role	Name	Date	Signature
Owner & Sponsor (approval authority)	Shaik Ishaq		
Product Owner (operational)	Nazir Hasan	2026-05-09	
Acting PM / Frontend Lead	Nazir Hasan	2026-05-09	
Backend Lead	Asrar		
Mobile Lead	Dheeraj		
WhatsApp / Operations Owner	TBD		
QA Lead	Najeeb		
Infrastructure Lead	Nayan		